Save Our Planet

with poems by Alan Brownjohn, Frank Farian and Giorgio & Gisela Sgarbi

- *Lines shown in blue are from the lyrics of We Kill the World by Frank Farian and Girogio & Gisela Sgarbi*
- *All other lines are from We are Going to see the Rabbit by Alan Brownjohn*

We are going to see the rabbit.

Which rabbit, ask the children? Which rabbit?

The only rabbit . . .the only rabbit in England,

Sitting behind a barbed-wire fence

Under the floodlights, neon lights, sodium lights,

Nibbling grass on the only patch of grass

In England, (except the grass by the hoardings, which doesn't count)

Where will this lead to

and what is this good for?

Poor world, is hurting bad,

Poor world, is doomed to die.

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INTRODUCTION

Is it too late to save our planet? One day we will find ourselves walking through concrete streets, searching for small signs of life we've almost wiped out. The trees? Gone. The fish? Struggling. The flowers? have Buried under parking lots. Do we care?

We pollute our world and mourn the loss of anything natural and real. I'll call this realness the "only rabbit" left. By the time we finally think to search for the "only rabbit," it's already slipped underground, hiding from our technology, our noise and our disrespect. And we're confused. Why does nature keep disappearing?

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First we shall go by escalator,

Then we shall go by underground,

And then we shall go by motorway,

And then by helicopterway,

And the last 10 yards we shall have to go

On foot.

We kill the world

We kill the world

'cause we don't know

what we are doing!

We are nearly there,
We are longing to see it,
And so is the crowd
Which is here in thousands
With mounted policemen
And big loudspeakers
And bands and banners.
Everyone has come a long way.

Where will this lead to
and what is this good for?
A Poor World, Poor World.
Fishes doomed to die
as people live close by
Parking lots will come
where flower fields were bright
as junkyard covers sight!

But soon we shall see it
Sitting and nibbling
The blades of grass
In – but something has gone wrong!
Why is everyone so angry,

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I see mushrooms, atomic mushrooms.
I see rockets, missiles in the sky.
Poor World, Poor World.

Why is everyone jostling and complaining?

Don't kill the world
don't let her down.
Don't kill the world
our means of life.
Lend ear to nature's cry.

The rabbit has gone,
Yes, the rabbit has gone.
He has actually burrowed down into the earth
And made himself a warren, under the earth,
Despite all these people.
What can we do?

Don't kill the world
She's all we have,
And surely is worth to save.
Don't let her die,
fight for her trees,
Pollution robs air to breathe.

Don't kill the world

help her survive

It is all a pity, you must be disappointed,

Go home again, go home for today.

Cherish the world.

On behalf of all creatures,

Care for the earth,

Foundation of life

Slow progress down help her survive

For you cannot hear the rabbit

Remarking rather sadly to himself, by himself,

As he rests in his warren, under the earth:

'It won't be long, they are bound to come,

They are bound to come and find me, even here.'

We kill the world

We kill the world

'cause we don't know

what we are doing!

A Poor World, Poor World.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

- ***Title: We are Going to see the Rabbit***
  Author: Alan Brownjohn
  Book: The Saner Places: Selected Poems
  ISBN: 978-1907587078
  Publisher: Enitharmon Press
  Date (Month/Year): July 2011

- ***Title: We Kill the World***
  Lyrics by: Frank Farian and Giorgio & Gisela Sgarbi
  Sheet Music: All-Sheet Music.com, Item #: 34-26-111
  https://www.all-sheetmusic.com/
  Release Date (Month/Year): Nov 1981
  Performed by Boney M from their 5th album, Boonoonoonoos

  Lyrics available online at
  https://www.streetdirectory.com/lyricadvisor/song/uopca/we_kill_the_world_dont_kill_the_world/

AWARD HISTORY

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